Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Independent surface and structure challenge

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 2 · Big question: How can we combine collagraph relief, foil embossing, and monochromatic wash in an architectural panel?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: When you brush a dark wash over embossed foil and wipe the top surface gently with a tissue, where does the dark ink stay?

Correct: Trapped down inside the indented lines and around the rivet bumps, making every detail stand out — Exactly! That intaglio-style wipe makes embossed foil look like aged cast metal.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Why must all PVA glue edges be pressed firm before you apply your monochromatic wash? -> So the card strips stay flat and the wash settles cleanly into the corners without lifting edges (Correct. Firmly bonded corners prevent buckling when wet media is applied.)

Q2: What does 'monochromatic' mean in our surface challenge today? -> Working with dark, mid, and light values of one colour family (such as iron grey, charcoal, and pale

chrome) (Yes. Removing rainbow colours lets the viewer focus purely on 3D form, shadow, and texture.)

Q3: How do you recover bright highlights if your dark wash makes the whole panel look too gloomy? -> Wipe raised foil edges with a damp tissue and skim dry chrome or white chalk across the top ridges (Spot on. Restoring the bright top values brings back the 3D contrast.)

Exit check answer

Question: What happens when you brush dark wash over embossed foil and gently wipe the raised top surface?

Correct: Dark pigment stays in the pressed grooves while the raised metal ridges shine brightly — Correct. This creates an instant weathered metal patina.